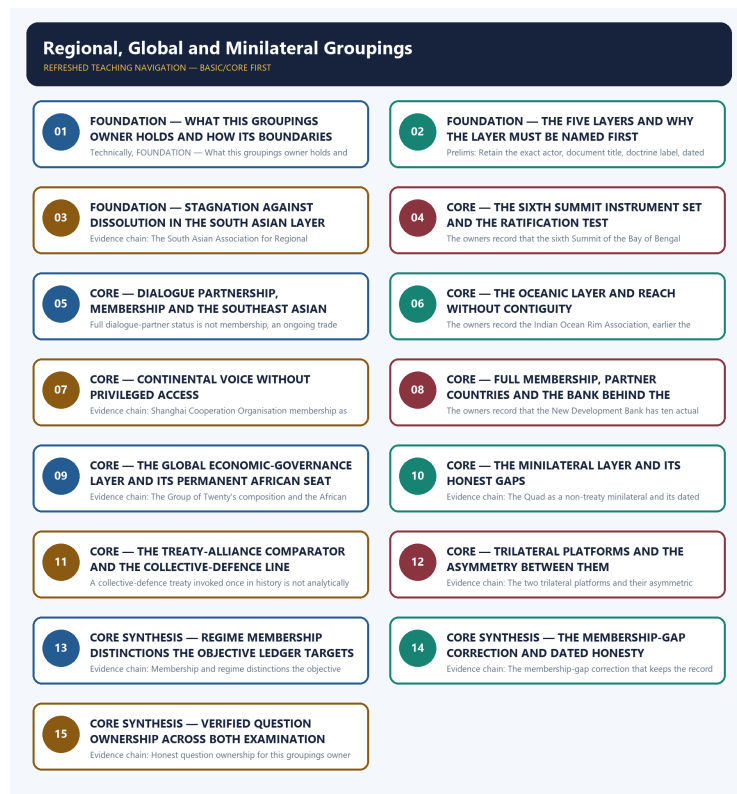


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Regional, Global and Minilateral Groupings - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Regional, Global and Minilateral Groupings - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this groupings owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. B. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. C. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. D. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q2. Which card should be filed under What this groupings owner holds and how its boundaries are routed in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. B. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. C. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. D. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this groupings owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. B. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based

regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. C. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. D. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this groupings owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. B. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. C. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. D. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional,

continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The five-layer architecture that classifies every grouping?

A. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. B. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. C. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. D. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global

economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q6. Which card should be filed under The five-layer architecture that classifies every grouping in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. B. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. C. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. D. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The five-layer architecture that classifies every grouping?

A. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. B. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. C. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. D. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The five-layer architecture that classifies every grouping?

A. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. B. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. C. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. D. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation and the difference between stagnation and dissolution?

A. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. B. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. C. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. D. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q10. Which card should be filed under The South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation and the difference between stagnation and dissolution in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. B. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. C. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the

forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. D. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation and the difference between stagnation and dissolution?

A. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. B. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. C. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. D. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment

approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation and the difference between stagnation and dissolution?

A. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. B. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. C. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. D. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies The Bay of Bengal grouping's institutional lineage and the Charter that formalised it?

A. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. B. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. C. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. D. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q14. Which card should be filed under The Bay of Bengal grouping's institutional lineage and the Charter that formalised it in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. B. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is

that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. C. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. D. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Bay of Bengal grouping's institutional lineage and the Charter that formalised it?

A. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. B. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. C. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. D. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue

partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Bay of Bengal grouping's institutional lineage and the Charter that formalised it?

A. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. B. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. C. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. D. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The sixth Summit instrument set and Bangkok Vision 2030?

A. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. B. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. C. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. D. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q18. Which card should be filed under The sixth Summit instrument set and Bangkok Vision 2030 in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. B. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a

vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. C. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. D. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The sixth Summit instrument set and Bangkok Vision 2030?

A. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. B. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. C. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. D. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created

through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The sixth Summit instrument set and Bangkok Vision 2030?

A. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. B. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. C. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. D. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Partial entry into force as the sharpest effectiveness datum?

A. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. B. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. C. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. D. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q22. Which card should be filed under Partial entry into force as the sharpest effectiveness datum in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. B. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available

demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. C. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communiqué; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. D. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Partial entry into force as the sharpest effectiveness datum?

A. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. B. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. C. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. D. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration

and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Partial entry into force as the sharpest effectiveness datum?

A. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. B. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. C. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. D. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The Association of Southeast Asian Nations and the India-ASEAN framework?

A. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. B. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. C. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. D. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q26. Which card should be filed under The Association of Southeast Asian Nations and the India-ASEAN framework in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders'

Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. B. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. C. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. D. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Association of Southeast Asian Nations and the India-ASEAN framework?

A. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. B. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. C. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and

they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. D. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Association of Southeast Asian Nations and the India-ASEAN framework?

A. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. B. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. C. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. D. The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New

Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The Indian Ocean Rim Association as the trans-regional oceanic layer?

A. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. B. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. C. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. D. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q30. Which card should be filed under The Indian Ocean Rim Association as the trans-regional oceanic layer in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. B. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. C. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. D. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Indian Ocean Rim Association as the trans-regional oceanic layer?

A. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. B. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. C. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue

partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. D. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Indian Ocean Rim Association as the trans-regional oceanic layer?

A. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. B. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. C. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. D. The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional

organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Shanghai Cooperation Organisation membership as voice without privileged access?

A. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

B. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions.

C. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026.

D. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q34. Which card should be filed under Shanghai Cooperation Organisation membership as voice without privileged access in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. B. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. C. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. D. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Shanghai Cooperation Organisation membership as voice without privileged access?

A. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. B. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a

Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. C. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. D. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Shanghai Cooperation Organisation membership as voice without privileged access?

A. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. B. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. C. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in

Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional unilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. D. The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies BRICS full membership against the partner-country category?

A. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. B. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. C. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative unilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather

than filled by assumption. D. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q38. Which card should be filed under BRICS full membership against the partner-country category in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. B. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. C. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. D. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit

but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of BRICS full membership against the partner-country category?

A. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. B. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. C. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. D. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and

further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about BRICS full membership against the partner-country category?

A. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. B. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. C. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. D. The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies The New Development Bank's actual against prospective membership?

A. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. B. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. C. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. D. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q42. Which card should be filed under The New Development Bank's actual against prospective membership in an International Relations answer?

A. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. B. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. C. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. D. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The New Development Bank's actual against prospective membership?

A. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that

Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. B. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. C. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. D. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The New Development Bank's actual against prospective membership?

A. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. B. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. C. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires

consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. D. The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the New Development Bank has ten actual members, namely the five founders together with Bangladesh in 2021, the United Arab Emirates in 2021, Egypt in 2023, Algeria in 2025 and Uzbekistan in 2026, and that several other states appear on its lists as prospective rather than actual members; the examinable point is that a development bank attached to a grouping has its own membership ladder that does not track the grouping's own membership or partner tiers, so an answer that reads a bank's prospective list as a settled membership figure misstates both institutions at once. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies The Group of Twenty's composition and the African Union's permanent membership?

A. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. B. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. C. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. D. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting

convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q46. Which card should be filed under The Group of Twenty's composition and the African Union's permanent membership in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. B. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. C. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. D. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role

rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Group of Twenty's composition and the African Union's permanent membership?

A. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. B. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. C. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. D. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Group of Twenty's composition and the African Union's permanent membership?

A. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. B. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. C. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. D. The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The Quad as a non-treaty minilateral and its dated meeting record?

A. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. B. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23

November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. C. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. D. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q50. Which card should be filed under The Quad as a non-treaty minilateral and its dated meeting record in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. B. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. C. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23

November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. D. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Quad as a non-treaty minilateral and its dated meeting record?

A. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. B. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. C. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. D. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral

Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Quad as a non-treaty minilateral and its dated meeting record?

A. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. B. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. C. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. D. The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the

Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The treaty alliance comparator and why it is not a Quad analogue?

A. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional multilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. B. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. C. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. D. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger.

Answer: A. Explanation: The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is

neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q54. Which card should be filed under The treaty alliance comparator and why it is not a Quad analogue in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. B. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. C. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. D. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Answer: B. Explanation: The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is

neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The treaty alliance comparator and why it is not a Quad analogue?

A. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. B. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. C. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. D. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Answer: C. Explanation: The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9

October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The treaty alliance comparator and why it is not a Quad analogue?

A. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. B. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. C. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. D. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024,

that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional unilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional unilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The two trilateral platforms and their asymmetric activity?

A. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. B. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. C. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. D. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or

Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q58. Which card should be filed under The two trilateral platforms and their asymmetric activity in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. B. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. C. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. D. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The two trilateral platforms and their asymmetric activity?

A. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. B. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. C. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. D. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The two trilateral platforms and their asymmetric activity?

A. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. B. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. C. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. D. The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Mekong-Ganga Cooperation and the subregional connectivity layer?

A. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. B. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. C. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. D. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q62. Which card should be filed under Mekong-Ganga Cooperation and the subregional connectivity layer in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. B. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its

dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. C. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. D. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Mekong-Ganga Cooperation and the subregional connectivity layer?

A. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. B. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a

15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. C. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. D. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Mekong-Ganga Cooperation and the subregional connectivity layer?

A. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. B. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association,

what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. C. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. D. The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record Mekong-Ganga Cooperation as a six-member ministerial cooperation mechanism linking India with Cambodia, Lao People's Democratic Republic, Myanmar, Thailand and Viet Nam under the broader Act East policy, and that the most recent ministerial meeting located officially is the tenth, at Bangkok on 1 August 2019; they route the physical connectivity projects that operationalise Act East, including the Kaladan multi-modal project and the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, to the neighbourhood owner, so this topic carries the mechanism and its dated meeting record while the corridor engineering and its delivery record belong elsewhere. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Membership and regime distinctions the objective paper tests directly?

A. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. B. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body

and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. C. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. D. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q66. Which card should be filed under Membership and regime distinctions the objective paper tests directly in an International Relations answer?

A. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction

block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. B. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. C. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. D. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Membership and regime distinctions the objective paper tests directly?

A. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a

comparison question penalises. B. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. C. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. D. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and multilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Membership and regime distinctions the objective paper tests directly?

A. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. B. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. C. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. D. The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies The membership-gap correction that keeps the record honest?

A. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. B. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. C. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. D. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q70. Which card should be filed under The membership-gap correction that keeps the record honest in an International Relations answer?

A. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. B. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. C. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. D. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The membership-gap correction that keeps the record honest?

A. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. B. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. C. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. D. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The membership-gap correction that keeps the record honest?

A. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. B. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. C. The owners sort

every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. D. The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Overlap as strategic-autonomy design and the coordination cost it carries?

A. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. B. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. C. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. D. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not

among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q74. Which card should be filed under Overlap as strategic-autonomy design and the coordination cost it carries in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. B. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. C. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai

Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. D. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Overlap as strategic-autonomy design and the coordination cost it carries?

A. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. B. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. C. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. D. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct

interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Overlap as strategic-autonomy design and the coordination cost it carries?

A. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. B. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. C. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. D. The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Honest question ownership for this groupings owner?

A. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. B. This topic owns India's participation across regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance and minilateral groupings as a single classification problem: which layer a body belongs to, what legal form it takes, what participation tier a state actually holds in it, which dated instrument it has produced and what claim that instrument can support; its distinctive feature is that overlapping membership is a deliberate design choice rather than diplomatic incoherence, and six General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2020, 2021, 2022 and 2023 are routed here alongside a long objective ledger running from 2018 to 2026, while the Quad's maritime-security profile belongs to topic 04, the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation's connectivity role to topic 05, the Global South category to topic 08 and the linkage between the Group of Twenty and United Nations or Bretton Woods reform to topic 12. C. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. D. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is

printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q78. Which card should be filed under Honest question ownership for this groupings owner in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. B. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. C. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. D. The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Honest question ownership for this groupings owner?

A. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. B. The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. C. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are

not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. D. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Honest question ownership for this groupings owner?

A. The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. B. The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. C. The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. D. The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question

19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Six General Studies Paper II Mains demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers and each is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word-limit provenance exactly as observed: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself into a trade bloc from a military alliance, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, 15 marks with the 250-word limit printed in the question; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, 10 marks with the 150-word limit printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, 15 marks with the 250-word limit printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, 10 marks; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization

and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, 15 marks. For all six the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership. Two provenance facts are reported rather than repaired: the 2020 General Studies Paper II is not among the locally held official papers, so that stem is carried from the audited ledger and the Basic owner and is expressly not confirmed here; and the two 2023 demands print only the mark value in their per-question tail, so their word limits are taken from that paper's own instruction block, which states that answers to Questions 1 to 10 should be in 150 words and answers to Questions 11 to 20 in 250 words. The 2021, 2022 and 2023 stems were confirmed word for word against the locally held official General Studies Paper II question papers for those years. The objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from the audited 2018-2023 papers, four from the audited 2024-2025 papers and three from the audited 2026 paper to this owner, covering Nuclear Suppliers Group membership consequences, India's Additional Protocol, ASEAN free-trade partners, separatist regions matched to countries, Group of Twenty membership, India's membership of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank, the Missile Technology Control Regime and the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, the Organization of Turkic States, country-event pairs, the European Union Trade and Technology Council, the European Union Stability and Growth Pact, the Group of Twenty's origin as a finance ministers' platform, North Atlantic Treaty Organization membership, the Bay of Bengal grouping, the sixteenth BRICS Summit at Kazan and BRICS membership, India-ASEAN multimodal connectivity corridors, BIMSTEC institutional centres matched to their locations and European Union membership status among selected European states. The official 2018-2023 objective keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key held locally is provisional, and in every case no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded, so none of these objective demands is converted into a solved answer. The Basic and Advanced owners also record that no General Studies Paper II Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers names one of these groupings as its sole framing device, and that absence is stated honestly instead of force-fitting an adjacent question. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording and word-limit provenance of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no stem was paraphrased into an apparent routing, and no marking scheme or official answer key was imported.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2020 GS-II**: "'Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (QUAD)' is transforming itself into a trade bloc from a military alliance, in present times - Discuss." Correct the premise: Quad is neither a treaty military alliance nor a trade bloc; evaluate its widening functional agenda.
- FACT: **2021 GS-II**: "Critically examine the aims and objectives of SCO. What importance does it hold for India?" - mandate, interests, constraints.
- FACT: **2022 GS-II**: "How will I2U2 (India, Israel, UAE and USA) grouping transform India's position in global politics?" - use West Asia, investment, technology and strategic-autonomy dimensions.
- ANALYSIS: No 2024-2025 question names one grouping as the sole subject; use the layered-grouping framework and dated BIMSTEC/BRICS anchors.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	66	India-ASEAN connectivity through regional multimodal transport infrastructure projects and corridors	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - ■2026 - ■GS1 - ■Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2026	Prelims GS-I	72	BIMSTEC institutional centres matched with their respective geographic locations	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - ■2026 - ■GS1 - ■Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2026	Prelims GS-I	75	European Union membership status among selected European nation-states	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans - ■2026 - ■GS1 - ■Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- India-ASEAN connectivity through regional multimodal transport infrastructure projects and corridors
- BIMSTEC institutional centres matched with their respective geographic locations
- European Union membership status among selected European nation-states

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	87	Country-news pairs (Argentina, Sudan, Turkey/NATO)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2025	Prelims GS-I	21	NATO member countries	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2025	Prelims GS-I	92	BIMSTEC	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2025	Prelims GS-I	97	16th BRICS Summit (Kazan) and BRICS membership	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Country-news pairs (Argentina, Sudan, Turkey/NATO)
- NATO member countries
- BIMSTEC
- 16th BRICS Summit (Kazan) and BRICS membership

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 17

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	7	Nuclear Suppliers Group membership consequences for a country	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	33	India IAEA Additional Protocol ratification and implications	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	34	ASEAN free-trade partner countries identification	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	90	Separatist regional areas matched with correct countries in news	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-II	19	Quadrilateral Security Dialogue shifting from alliance to trade bloc	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	Prelims GS-I	65	G20 member countries identification and groupings	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	GS-II	19	Aims and objectives of the SCO and its importance for India	Critically examine · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	10	BIMSTEC compared with SAARC and foreign policy objectives	Do you think and how are they similar · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	19	I2U2 grouping and India's position in global politics	How will it transform · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	Prelims GS-I	66	India membership in AIIB MTCR and SCO groupings	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	83	Organization of Turkic States member countries identification	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	87	Countries recent political events Chad Guinea Lebanon Tunisia	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	GS-II	9	Conflict affecting the functioning of the SCO and India's role	Point out the role · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	19	Expansion of NATO and a stronger US-Europe partnership for India	What is your opinion with reasons · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	87	USA EU Trade and Technology Council launch objectives	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	89	EU Stability and Growth Pact budgetary deficit obligations	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	Prelims GS-I	100	G-20 origin as Finance Ministers platform India priorities	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Nuclear Suppliers Group membership consequences for a country
- India IAEA Additional Protocol ratification and implications
- ASEAN free-trade partner countries identification
- Separatist regional areas matched with correct countries in news
- Quadrilateral Security Dialogue shifting from alliance to trade bloc
- G20 member countries identification and groupings
- Aims and objectives of the SCO and its importance for India
- BIMSTEC compared with SAARC and foreign policy objectives
- I2U2 grouping and India's position in global politics
- India membership in AIIB MTCR and SCO groupings
- Organization of Turkic States member countries identification
- Countries recent political events Chad Guinea Lebanon Tunisia
- Conflict affecting the functioning of the SCO and India's role
- Expansion of NATO and a stronger US-Europe partnership for India
- USA EU Trade and Technology Council launch objectives
- EU Stability and Growth Pact budgetary deficit obligations
- G-20 origin as Finance Ministers platform India priorities

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2020 Quad PYQ**: reject the question's alliance/trade-bloc premise before evaluating functional expansion.
- FACT: **2021 SCO PYQ**: assess aims and objectives against India's continental security/connectivity interests and Pakistan-China constraints.
- FACT: **2022 I2U2 PYQ**: analyse transformation of India's global position through issue-based minilateralism, not bloc alignment.
- ANALYSIS: No 2024-2025 question directly names a single grouping. An advanced analytical answer should:
 1. Categorise groupings by layer (regional, trans-regional, continental, global-governance, minilateral) rather than listing them undifferentiated.
 2. Distinguish institutional-effectiveness levels (treaty-bound vs. non-treaty).
 3. Cite the BIMSTEC Charter, Bangkok Vision 2030, the BRICS Rio de Janeiro Declaration and India's BRICS 2026 chairship launch at the correct evidentiary level, and distinguish full membership from partner/observer tiers.
 4. Acknowledge membership gaps (APEC/ASEM) honestly rather than presenting

uniform diplomatic success.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 6

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	GS-II	19	Quadrilateral Security Dialogue shifting from alliance to trade bloc	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2021	GS-II	19	Aims and objectives of the SCO and its importance for India	Critically examine · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	10	BIMSTEC compared with SAARC and foreign policy objectives	Do you think and how are they similar · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-II	19	I2U2 grouping and India's position in global politics	How will it transform · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	9	Conflict affecting the functioning of the SCO and India's role	Point out the role · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	19	Expansion of NATO and a stronger US-Europe partnership for India	What is your opinion with reasons · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; word limit taken from the instruction block	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Quadrilateral Security Dialogue shifting from alliance to trade bloc
- Aims and objectives of the SCO and its importance for India
- BIMSTEC compared with SAARC and foreign policy objectives
- I2U2 grouping and India's position in global politics
- Conflict affecting the functioning of the SCO and India's role
- Expansion of NATO and a stronger US-Europe partnership for India

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 19

Demand: 'Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (QUAD)' is transforming itself into a trade bloc from a military alliance, in present times - Discuss. A Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and in the Basic owner. The 2020 General Studies Paper II is not among the locally held official papers, so this wording is reproduced from the audited ledger and the owner and is expressly not confirmed against an official paper held here.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed, and the absence of a locally held 2020 paper is reported rather than repaired by invented wording.

Model solution: Claim: the premise must be corrected before it is discussed, because the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue is neither a military alliance that it could transform from nor a trade bloc that it could transform into; what the evidence actually shows is a non-treaty consultative minilateral widening its functional agenda while acquiring no collective-defence obligation and no common external tariff. Named evidence and example: the owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships; its most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and its most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, while the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; against this, the North Atlantic Treaty Organization pages checked on 2026-09-03 record a treaty signed by twelve states on 4 April 1949 at Washington, D.C. and ratified by all twelve parliaments within five months, whose Article 5 collective-defence commitment has been invoked once in its history, after the attacks of 11 September 2001, with the North Atlantic Council confirming the determination on 2 October 2001 and Operation Eagle Assist running from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002. Analysis: the widening agenda from maritime domain awareness toward critical minerals, energy security and supply-chain resilience is real and datable, but each new limb is an initiative or framework rather than a ratified instrument, so the coalition gains functional breadth without acquiring either the obligation structure of an alliance or the tariff and rules-of-origin machinery of a trade bloc; the correct description is agenda expansion inside a stable non-treaty form, which is exactly why it remains attractive to a state that protects its strategic autonomy. Qualification: the discussion must concede that the announced Leaders' Summit to be hosted by India is neither recorded as held nor formally postponed, that initiatives announced at a ministerial meeting are announcements rather than delivery, that the coalition's members hold asymmetric treaty relationships among themselves which the grouping does not equalise, and that the maritime-security substance itself is owned by topic 04 and must be cited rather than re-argued here. Why this earns marks: it refuses a false premise instead of arguing inside it, dates every limb of the widening agenda, and uses a verified treaty alliance as the control case that makes the classification decisive.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 19", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the premise must be corrected before it is discussed, because the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue is neither a military alliance that it could transform from nor a trade bloc that it could transform into; what the evidence actually shows is a non-treaty consultative minilateral widening its functional agenda while acquiring no collective-defence obligation and no common external tariff. Named evidence and example: the owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships; its most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and its most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, while the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; against this, the North Atlantic Treaty Organization pages checked on 2026-09-03 record a treaty signed by twelve states on 4 April 1949 at Washington, D.C. and ratified by all twelve parliaments within five months, whose Article 5 collective-defence commitment has been invoked once in its history, after the attacks of 11

September 2001, with the North Atlantic Council confirming the determination on 2 October 2001 and Operation Eagle Assist running from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002. Analysis: the widening agenda from maritime domain awareness toward critical minerals, energy security and supply-chain resilience is real and datable, but each new limb is an initiative or framework rather than a ratified instrument, so the coalition gains functional breadth without acquiring either the obligation structure of an alliance or the tariff and rules-of-origin machinery of a trade bloc; the correct description is agenda expansion inside a stable non-treaty form, which is exactly why it remains attractive to a state that protects its strategic autonomy. Qualification: the discussion must concede that the announced Leaders' Summit to be hosted by India is neither recorded as held nor formally postponed, that initiatives announced at a ministerial meeting are announcements rather than delivery, that the coalition's members hold asymmetric treaty relationships among themselves which the grouping does not equalise, and that the maritime-security substance itself is owned by topic 04 and must be cited rather than re-argued here. Why this earns marks: it refuses a false premise instead of arguing inside it, dates every limb of the widening agenda, and uses a verified treaty alliance as the control case that makes the classification decisive.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 19 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the premise must be corrected before it is discussed, because the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue is neither a military alliance that it could transform from nor a trade bloc that it could transform into; what the evidence actually shows is a non-treaty consultative minilateral widening its functional agenda while acquiring no collective-defence obligation and no common external tariff. Named evidence and example: the owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships; its most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and its most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, while the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; against this, the North Atlantic Treaty Organization pages checked on 2026-09-03 record a treaty signed by twelve states on 4 April 1949 at Washington, D.C. and ratified by all twelve parliaments within five months, whose Article 5 collective-defence commitment has been invoked once in its history, after the attacks of 11 September 2001, with the North Atlantic Council confirming the determination on 2 October 2001 and Operation Eagle Assist running from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002. Analysis: the widening agenda from maritime domain awareness toward critical minerals, energy security and supply-chain resilience is real and datable, but each new limb is an initiative or framework rather than a ratified instrument, so the coalition gains functional breadth without acquiring either the obligation structure of an alliance or the tariff and rules-of-origin machinery of a trade bloc; the correct description is agenda expansion inside a stable non-treaty form, which is exactly why it remains attractive to a state that protects its strategic autonomy. Qualification: the discussion must concede that the announced Leaders' Summit to be hosted by India is neither recorded as held nor formally postponed, that initiatives announced at a ministerial meeting are announcements rather than delivery, that the coalition's members hold asymmetric treaty relationships among themselves which the grouping does not equalise, and that the maritime-security substance itself is owned by topic 04 and must be cited rather than re-argued here. Why this earns marks: it refuses a false premise instead of arguing inside it, dates every limb of the widening agenda, and uses a verified treaty alliance as the control case that makes the classification decisive.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2020 General Studies Paper II Question 19", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 19

Demand: Critically examine the aims and objectives of SCO. What importance does it hold for India? (Answer in 250 words). A 15-mark demand whose word limit is printed in the question itself, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and confirmed word for word against the locally held official paper.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation matters to India as a continental seat rather than as a bloc, so its aims are best assessed against what a charter-based Eurasian body can deliver to a member whose principal rivals sit inside it. Named evidence and example: the owners record it as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners; India became a full member in 2017; the 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; and India's parallel platforms in the same portfolio include the Indian Ocean Rim Association, where it assumed the chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027 and whose twenty-fourth Council of Ministers adopted the Colombo Communique on 21 May 2025. Analysis: the organisation's security and economic aims give India standing in Eurasian dialogue that no bilateral channel supplies, and dated summit documents give an Indian position a multilateral audience, but the same membership that creates the seat also caps its yield, because a body containing Pakistan and China cannot advance India-specific priorities without negotiation and compromise; the critical judgement is therefore that the organisation is valuable as one layer of a diversified portfolio and misleading if treated as a vehicle for India's continental objectives on its own. Qualification: the examination must state that common membership never implies common threat perceptions, that a declaration is a summit outcome document rather than a binding commitment, that the organisation's connectivity and Central Asia detail is owned by topic 05 and cited rather than duplicated, and that a chairship held by another member is a rotation fact and not a shift in the organisation's mandate. Why this earns marks: it answers both limbs of the question, uses dated documents rather than general claims about Eurasian cooperation, and delivers a graded verdict that names the exact structural reason the body's value is bounded.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 19", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation matters to India as a continental seat rather than as a bloc, so its aims are best assessed against what a charter-based Eurasian body can deliver to a member whose principal rivals sit inside it. Named evidence and example: the owners record it as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners; India became a full member in 2017; the 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; and India's parallel platforms in the same portfolio include the Indian Ocean Rim Association, where it assumed the chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027 and whose twenty-fourth Council of Ministers adopted the Colombo Communique on 21 May 2025. Analysis: the organisation's security and economic aims give India standing in Eurasian dialogue that no bilateral channel supplies, and dated summit documents give an Indian position a multilateral audience, but the same membership that creates the seat also caps its yield, because a body containing Pakistan and China cannot advance India-specific priorities without negotiation and compromise; the critical judgement is therefore that the organisation is valuable as one layer of a diversified portfolio and misleading if treated as a vehicle for India's continental objectives on its own. Qualification: the examination must state that common membership never implies common threat perceptions, that a declaration is a summit outcome document rather than a binding commitment, that the organisation's connectivity and Central Asia detail is owned by topic 05 and cited rather than duplicated, and that a chairship held by another member is a rotation fact and not a shift in the

organisation's mandate. Why this earns marks: it answers both limbs of the question, uses dated documents rather than general claims about Eurasian cooperation, and delivers a graded verdict that names the exact structural reason the body's value is bounded.

Analytical body:

1. Claim and named evidence: PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 19 **Analysis:**

Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation matters to India as a continental seat rather than as a bloc, so its aims are best assessed against what a charter-based Eurasian body can deliver to a member whose principal rivals sit inside it. Named evidence and example: the owners record it as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners; India became a full member in 2017; the 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; and India's parallel platforms in the same portfolio include the Indian Ocean Rim Association, where it assumed the chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027 and whose twenty-fourth Council of Ministers adopted the Colombo Communique on 21 May 2025. Analysis: the organisation's security and economic aims give India standing in Eurasian dialogue that no bilateral channel supplies, and dated summit documents give an Indian position a multilateral audience, but the same membership that creates the seat also caps its yield, because a body containing Pakistan and China cannot advance India-specific priorities without negotiation and compromise; the critical judgement is therefore that the organisation is valuable as one layer of a diversified portfolio and misleading if treated as a vehicle for India's continental objectives on its own. Qualification: the examination must state that common membership never implies common threat perceptions, that a declaration is a summit outcome document rather than a binding commitment, that the organisation's connectivity and Central Asia detail is owned by topic 05 and cited rather than duplicated, and that a chairship held by another member is a rotation fact and not a shift in the organisation's mandate. Why this earns marks: it answers both limbs of the question, uses dated documents rather than general claims about Eurasian cooperation, and delivers a graded verdict that names the exact structural reason the body's value is bounded.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 19", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 10

Demand: Do you think that BIMSTEC is a parallel organisation like the SAARC? What are the similarities and dissimilarities between the two? How are Indian foreign policy objectives realized by forming this new organisation? (Answer in 150 words). A 10-mark demand whose word limit is printed in the question itself, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and confirmed word for word against the locally held official paper.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the Bay of Bengal grouping is not a parallel organisation but a differently scoped one whose relative salience has risen as the South Asian association's summit momentum has been constrained, and India's objectives are realised through that difference in scope rather than through substitution. Named evidence and example: the owners record the South Asian association as a charter-based body of eight members with an observer

tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and the Bay of Bengal grouping as a charter-based body of seven members whose Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, and which was renamed from the earlier Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping; the sixth Summit at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report with Bangladesh taking the chair; and the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation, signed on 3 April 2025, entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand. Analysis: the similarities are institutional, since both are charter-based regional organisations with overlapping South Asian membership and a technical and economic cooperation mandate; the dissimilarities are decisive, since the Bay of Bengal grouping is organised around a maritime region that links South and Southeast Asia, excludes the bilateral relationship that has constrained the older body, and has produced dated instruments within a single recent cycle, which is precisely what allows India to pursue connectivity and Act East objectives without waiting on a stalled forum. Qualification: the answer must state that the older association continues to exist and has not been formally replaced, that a vision document and rules of procedure are not treaty obligations, that entry into force among four of seven members is not regional bindingness, and that only a framework agreement from 8 February 2004 exists for a free trade area. Why this earns marks: it corrects the parallel-organisation premise, gives similarities and dissimilarities on named institutional axes, and evidences the objective claim with instruments dated inside a single verifiable cycle.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 10", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the Bay of Bengal grouping is not a parallel organisation but a differently scoped one whose relative salience has risen as the South Asian association's summit momentum has been constrained, and India's objectives are realised through that difference in scope rather than through substitution. Named evidence and example: the owners record the South Asian association as a charter-based body of eight members with an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and the Bay of Bengal grouping as a charter-based body of seven members whose Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, and which was renamed from the earlier Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping; the sixth Summit at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report with Bangladesh taking the chair; and the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation, signed on 3 April 2025, entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand. Analysis: the similarities are institutional, since both are charter-based regional organisations with overlapping South Asian membership and a technical and economic cooperation mandate; the dissimilarities are decisive, since the Bay of Bengal grouping is organised around a maritime region that links South and Southeast Asia, excludes the bilateral relationship that has constrained the older body, and has produced dated instruments within a single recent cycle, which is precisely what allows India to pursue connectivity and Act East objectives without waiting on a stalled forum. Qualification: the answer must state that the older association continues to exist and has not been formally replaced, that a vision document and rules of procedure are not treaty obligations, that entry into force among four of seven members is not regional bindingness, and that only a framework agreement from 8 February 2004 exists for a free trade area. Why this earns marks: it corrects the parallel-organisation premise, gives similarities and dissimilarities on named institutional axes, and evidences the objective claim with instruments dated inside a single verifiable cycle.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 10 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or

strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the Bay of Bengal grouping is not a parallel organisation but a differently scoped one whose relative salience has risen as the South Asian association's summit momentum has been constrained, and India's objectives are realised through that difference in scope rather than through substitution. Named evidence and example: the owners record the South Asian association as a charter-based body of eight members with an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and the Bay of Bengal grouping as a charter-based body of seven members whose Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, and which was renamed from the earlier Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping; the sixth Summit at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report with Bangladesh taking the chair; and the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation, signed on 3 April 2025, entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand. Analysis: the similarities are institutional, since both are charter-based regional organisations with overlapping South Asian membership and a technical and economic cooperation mandate; the dissimilarities are decisive, since the Bay of Bengal grouping is organised around a maritime region that links South and Southeast Asia, excludes the bilateral relationship that has constrained the older body, and has produced dated instruments within a single recent cycle, which is precisely what allows India to pursue connectivity and Act East objectives without waiting on a stalled forum. Qualification: the answer must state that the older association continues to exist and has not been formally replaced, that a vision document and rules of procedure are not treaty obligations, that entry into force among four of seven members is not regional bindingness, and that only a framework agreement from 8 February 2004 exists for a free trade area. Why this earns marks: it corrects the parallel-organisation premise, gives similarities and dissimilarities on named institutional axes, and evidences the objective claim with instruments dated inside a single verifiable cycle.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 10", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 19

Demand: How will I2U2 (India, Israel, UAE and USA) grouping transform India's position in global politics? (Answer in 250 words). A 15-mark demand whose word limit is printed in the question itself, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and confirmed word for word against the locally held official paper.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the transformation is real but categorical rather than dramatic, because I2U2 changes the kind of platform through which India acts rather than the quantum of power it holds, moving it from bloc-shaped alignment toward issue-based minilateral coordination. Named evidence and example: the owners classify I2U2, alongside the Quad and the Russia-India-China trilateral, in the minilateral and issue-based layer defined by small self-selected membership around one or two functional issues without geographic contiguity and without binding treaty commitment, and they list its functional field as food, water, energy and technology cooperation; the contrast cases in the same architecture are the charter-based Bay of Bengal grouping, whose Charter entered into force on 20 May 2024, and the non-treaty Quad, whose Foreign Ministers announced initiatives at New Delhi on 26 May 2026 without any ratification step; the same portfolio also carries the Indian Ocean Rim Association chaired by India for 2025 to 2027 and the Group of Twenty, where the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023. Analysis: minilateral coordination lets India assemble capital, technology and market access from partners it could not join in a single formal organisation, and it does so without importing the political cost of a bloc, which is why the transformation is best described as an expansion of India's usable instruments rather than a change of camp; the strategic-autonomy payoff is structural, because a portfolio in which no single platform is existentially necessary absorbs stagnation in any one of them. Qualification: the assessment must state that a minilateral produces no treaty obligation and therefore no guaranteed delivery, that West Asian regional exposure and its energy dimension are

owned by topic 06 and must be cited rather than re-argued, that announced projects are announcements until dated implementation is shown, and that a small self-selected grouping cannot substitute for the formal institutions where rules are actually written. Why this earns marks: it answers the transformation question in the correct analytical register, places the grouping inside a named architecture rather than describing it in isolation, and refuses to convert an issue-based coalition into a claim of systemic power.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 19", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the transformation is real but categorical rather than dramatic, because I2U2 changes the kind of platform through which India acts rather than the quantum of power it holds, moving it from bloc-shaped alignment toward issue-based minilateral coordination. Named evidence and example: the owners classify I2U2, alongside the Quad and the Russia-India-China trilateral, in the minilateral and issue-based layer defined by small self-selected membership around one or two functional issues without geographic contiguity and without binding treaty commitment, and they list its functional field as food, water, energy and technology cooperation; the contrast cases in the same architecture are the charter-based Bay of Bengal grouping, whose Charter entered into force on 20 May 2024, and the non-treaty Quad, whose Foreign Ministers announced initiatives at New Delhi on 26 May 2026 without any ratification step; the same portfolio also carries the Indian Ocean Rim Association chaired by India for 2025 to 2027 and the Group of Twenty, where the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023. Analysis: minilateral coordination lets India assemble capital, technology and market access from partners it could not join in a single formal organisation, and it does so without importing the political cost of a bloc, which is why the transformation is best described as an expansion of India's usable instruments rather than a change of camp; the strategic-autonomy payoff is structural, because a portfolio in which no single platform is existentially necessary absorbs stagnation in any one of them. Qualification: the assessment must state that a minilateral produces no treaty obligation and therefore no guaranteed delivery, that West Asian regional exposure and its energy dimension are owned by topic 06 and must be cited rather than re-argued, that announced projects are announcements until dated implementation is shown, and that a small self-selected grouping cannot substitute for the formal institutions where rules are actually written. Why this earns marks: it answers the transformation question in the correct analytical register, places the grouping inside a named architecture rather than describing it in isolation, and refuses to convert an issue-based coalition into a claim of systemic power.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 19 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the transformation is real but categorical rather than dramatic, because I2U2 changes the kind of platform through which India acts rather than the quantum of power it holds, moving it from bloc-shaped alignment toward issue-based minilateral coordination. Named evidence and example: the owners classify I2U2, alongside the Quad and the Russia-India-China trilateral, in the minilateral and issue-based layer defined by small self-selected membership around one or two functional issues without geographic contiguity and without binding treaty commitment, and they list its functional field as food, water, energy and technology cooperation; the contrast cases in the same architecture are the charter-based Bay of Bengal grouping, whose Charter entered into force on 20 May 2024, and the non-treaty Quad, whose Foreign Ministers announced initiatives at New Delhi on 26 May 2026 without any ratification step; the same portfolio also carries the Indian Ocean Rim Association chaired by India for 2025 to 2027 and the Group of Twenty, where the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023. Analysis: minilateral coordination lets India assemble capital, technology and market access from partners it could not

join in a single formal organisation, and it does so without importing the political cost of a bloc, which is why the transformation is best described as an expansion of India's usable instruments rather than a change of camp; the strategic-autonomy payoff is structural, because a portfolio in which no single platform is existentially necessary absorbs stagnation in any one of them. Qualification: the assessment must state that a minilateral produces no treaty obligation and therefore no guaranteed delivery, that West Asian regional exposure and its energy dimension are owned by topic 06 and must be cited rather than re-argued, that announced projects are announcements until dated implementation is shown, and that a small self-selected grouping cannot substitute for the formal institutions where rules are actually written. Why this earns marks: it answers the transformation question in the correct analytical register, places the grouping inside a named architecture rather than describing it in isolation, and refuses to convert an issue-based coalition into a claim of systemic power.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 General Studies Paper II Question 19", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 9

Demand: 'Virus of Conflict is affecting the functioning of the SCO' In the light of the above statement point out the role of India in mitigating the problems. A 10-mark demand, confirmed word for word against the locally held official paper, whose printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; the 150-word limit is taken from the paper's instruction block, which states that answers to Questions 1 to 10 should be in 150 words and answers to Questions 11 to 20 in 250 words.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership and where the word limit is recorded as taken from the paper's instruction block. That instruction block was read directly in the locally held official paper and is reported here rather than reconstructed. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the conflict named in the stem operates inside the membership rather than outside it, so India's mitigating role is to keep the organisation functional as a dialogue seat while refusing to let it carry claims its own decision structure cannot support. Named evidence and example: the owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners; India became a full member in 2017; the 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; and the same five-layer architecture gives India alternatives if this seat yields little, including the Indian Ocean Rim Association, chaired by India for 2025 to 2027, whose twenty-fourth Council of Ministers adopted the Colombo Communique on 21 May 2025, and the trilateral platforms named by Sikri, of which the Russia-India-China format has no officially verified meeting since the virtual eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting of 26 November 2021. Analysis: because a charter-based intergovernmental body decides among members with divergent threat perceptions, an unresolved conflict inside the membership converts an ordinary procedural step into a bargaining chokepoint, and the organisation's output migrates toward declaratory language that every member can accept; India's mitigating contribution is therefore threefold, namely sustaining participation for the continental access it supplies, pressing positions such as counter-terrorism and connectivity language that can survive that filter, and building parallel platforms so that no single blocked forum determines its Eurasian standing. Qualification: the answer must state that common membership never implies common threat perceptions, that a declaration is a summit outcome document and not a binding commitment, that the organisation's connectivity and Central Asia detail is owned by topic 05 and cited rather than duplicated, and that the dormancy of the Russia-India-China format is a verified absence of a recorded meeting rather than an inference about any member's intent. Why this earns marks: it answers the exact directive by pointing out India's role, explains the constraint mechanically instead of describing it, and closes with a bounded judgement that neither overstates Indian influence nor writes the organisation off.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 9", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the conflict named in the stem operates inside the membership rather than outside it, so India's mitigating role is to keep the organisation functional as a dialogue seat while refusing to let it carry claims its own decision structure cannot support. Named evidence and example: the owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners; India became a full member in 2017; the 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; and the same five-layer architecture gives India alternatives if this seat yields little, including the Indian Ocean Rim Association, chaired by India for 2025 to 2027, whose twenty-fourth Council of Ministers adopted the Colombo Communique on 21 May 2025, and the trilateral platforms named by Sikri, of which the Russia-India-China format has no officially verified meeting since the virtual eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting of 26 November 2021. Analysis: because a charter-based intergovernmental body decides among members with divergent threat perceptions, an unresolved conflict inside the membership converts an ordinary procedural step into a bargaining chokepoint, and the organisation's output migrates toward declaratory language that every member can accept; India's mitigating contribution is therefore threefold, namely sustaining participation for the continental access it supplies, pressing positions such as counter-terrorism and connectivity language that can survive that filter, and building parallel platforms so that no single blocked forum determines its Eurasian standing. Qualification: the answer must state that common membership never implies common threat perceptions, that a declaration is a summit outcome document and not a binding commitment, that the organisation's connectivity and Central Asia detail is owned by topic 05 and cited rather than duplicated, and that the dormancy of the Russia-India-China format is a verified absence of a recorded meeting rather than an inference about any member's intent. Why this earns marks: it answers the exact directive by pointing out India's role, explains the constraint mechanically instead of describing it, and closes with a bounded judgement that neither overstates Indian influence nor writes the organisation off.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 9 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the conflict named in the stem operates inside the membership rather than outside it, so India's mitigating role is to keep the organisation functional as a dialogue seat while refusing to let it carry claims its own decision structure cannot support. Named evidence and example: the owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners; India became a full member in 2017; the 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; and the same five-layer architecture gives India alternatives if this seat yields little, including the Indian Ocean Rim Association, chaired by India for 2025 to 2027, whose twenty-fourth Council of Ministers adopted the Colombo Communique on 21 May 2025, and the trilateral platforms named by Sikri, of which the Russia-India-China format has no officially verified meeting since the virtual eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting of 26 November 2021. Analysis: because a charter-based intergovernmental body decides among members with divergent threat perceptions, an unresolved conflict inside the membership converts an ordinary procedural step into a bargaining chokepoint, and the organisation's output migrates toward declaratory language that every member can accept; India's mitigating contribution is therefore threefold, namely

sustaining participation for the continental access it supplies, pressing positions such as counter-terrorism and connectivity language that can survive that filter, and building parallel platforms so that no single blocked forum determines its Eurasian standing. Qualification: the answer must state that common membership never implies common threat perceptions, that a declaration is a summit outcome document and not a binding commitment, that the organisation's connectivity and Central Asia detail is owned by topic 05 and cited rather than duplicated, and that the dormancy of the Russia-India-China format is a verified absence of a recorded meeting rather than an inference about any member's intent. Why this earns marks: it answers the exact directive by pointing out India's role, explains the constraint mechanically instead of describing it, and closes with a bounded judgement that neither overstates Indian influence nor writes the organisation off.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 9", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 19

Demand: 'The expansion and strengthening of NATO and a stronger US-Europe strategic partnership works well for India.' What is your opinion about this statement? Give reasons and examples to support your answer. A 15-mark demand, confirmed word for word against the locally held official paper, whose printed per-question tail carries only the mark value; the 250-word limit is taken from the paper's instruction block, which states that answers to Questions 11 to 20 should be in 250 words.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership and where the word limit is recorded as taken from the paper's instruction block. That instruction block was read directly in the locally held official paper and is reported here rather than reconstructed. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the statement is partly defensible and must be split, because a stronger United States-Europe partnership does open real technology, defence-industrial and market channels for India, while alliance expansion itself transmits costs that a favourable verdict must not conceal. Named evidence and example: the North Atlantic Treaty Organization pages checked on 2026-09-03 record the treaty signed by twelve states at Washington, D.C. on 4 April 1949 and ratified by all twelve parliaments within five months, and record that Article 5 has been invoked once in the alliance's history, after 11 September 2001, with a conditional Council determination on 12 September 2001, confirmation on 2 October 2001, an eight-measure support package on 4 October 2001 and Operation Eagle Assist from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 involving seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally. Analysis: the benefit runs through convergence, since a coordinated Euro-Atlantic space deepens India-Europe defence, technology and market engagement and multiplies the partners available for supply diversification; the cost runs through three transmission channels the owners name, namely deepened Russia-West confrontation that pressures India's defence spares, energy sourcing, payments and diplomatic balancing, a possible reallocation of Western attention and defence-industrial capacity toward Europe, and tighter export-control and sanctions coordination that can restrict Indian firms and partnerships. Qualification: the opinion must state that India is outside the alliance and analyses transmission rather than membership, that the alliance must never be conflated with the Quad because collective defence is a treaty obligation the Quad does not carry, that the appropriate Indian response is diversification of defence supply, deeper India-Europe ties and issue-based Russia engagement without importing alliance logic into the Indo-Pacific, and that no prediction is offered about any specific future accession or operation. Why this earns marks: it gives a reasoned split verdict instead of a blanket agreement, supports each limb with verified official detail and named transmission channels, and closes with a policy stance that follows from the analysis.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 19", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints,

objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the statement is partly defensible and must be split, because a stronger United States-Europe partnership does open real technology, defence-industrial and market channels for India, while alliance expansion itself transmits costs that a favourable verdict must not conceal. Named evidence and example: the North Atlantic Treaty Organization pages checked on 2026-09-03 record the treaty signed by twelve states at Washington, D.C. on 4 April 1949 and ratified by all twelve parliaments within five months, and record that Article 5 has been invoked once in the alliance's history, after 11 September 2001, with a conditional Council determination on 12 September 2001, confirmation on 2 October 2001, an eight-measure support package on 4 October 2001 and Operation Eagle Assist from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 involving seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally. Analysis: the benefit runs through convergence, since a coordinated Euro-Atlantic space deepens India-Europe defence, technology and market engagement and multiplies the partners available for supply diversification; the cost runs through three transmission channels the owners name, namely deepened Russia-West confrontation that pressures India's defence spares, energy sourcing, payments and diplomatic balancing, a possible reallocation of Western attention and defence-industrial capacity toward Europe, and tighter export-control and sanctions coordination that can restrict Indian firms and partnerships. Qualification: the opinion must state that India is outside the alliance and analyses transmission rather than membership, that the alliance must never be conflated with the Quad because collective defence is a treaty obligation the Quad does not carry, that the appropriate Indian response is diversification of defence supply, deeper India-Europe ties and issue-based Russia engagement without importing alliance logic into the Indo-Pacific, and that no prediction is offered about any specific future accession or operation. Why this earns marks: it gives a reasoned split verdict instead of a blanket agreement, supports each limb with verified official detail and named transmission channels, and closes with a policy stance that follows from the analysis.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 19 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the statement is partly defensible and must be split, because a stronger United States-Europe partnership does open real technology, defence-industrial and market channels for India, while alliance expansion itself transmits costs that a favourable verdict must not conceal. Named evidence and example: the North Atlantic Treaty Organization pages checked on 2026-09-03 record the treaty signed by twelve states at Washington, D.C. on 4 April 1949 and ratified by all twelve parliaments within five months, and record that Article 5 has been invoked once in the alliance's history, after 11 September 2001, with a conditional Council determination on 12 September 2001, confirmation on 2 October 2001, an eight-measure support package on 4 October 2001 and Operation Eagle Assist from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 involving seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally. Analysis: the benefit runs through convergence, since a coordinated Euro-Atlantic space deepens India-Europe defence, technology and market engagement and multiplies the partners available for supply diversification; the cost runs through three transmission channels the owners name, namely deepened Russia-West confrontation that pressures India's defence spares, energy sourcing, payments and diplomatic balancing, a possible reallocation of Western attention and defence-industrial capacity toward Europe, and tighter export-control and sanctions coordination that can restrict Indian firms and partnerships. Qualification: the

opinion must state that India is outside the alliance and analyses transmission rather than membership, that the alliance must never be conflated with the Quad because collective defence is a treaty obligation the Quad does not carry, that the appropriate Indian response is diversification of defence supply, deeper India-Europe ties and issue-based Russia engagement without importing alliance logic into the Indo-Pacific, and that no prediction is offered about any specific future accession or operation. Why this earns marks: it gives a reasoned split verdict instead of a blanket agreement, supports each limb with verified official detail and named transmission channels, and closes with a policy stance that follows from the analysis.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2023 General Studies Paper II Question 19", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish regionalism from minilateralism as organising principles for India's diplomatic engagement, with reference to dated institutional evidence. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The two principles differ in membership logic, legal form and the kind of outcome each can produce, so the distinction must be drawn on those axes and evidenced with a charter-based regional body and a non-treaty coalition rather than asserted as a definitional contrast.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises.
- The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.
- The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption.
- The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different

claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified.

Qualified conclusion: The two principles differ in membership logic, legal form and the kind of outcome each can produce, so the distinction must be drawn on those axes and evidenced with a charter-based regional body and a non-treaty coalition rather than asserted as a definitional contrast.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish regionalism from minilateralism as organising principles for India's diplomatic...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The two principles differ in membership logic, legal form and the kind of outcome each can produce, so the distinction must be drawn on those axes and evidenced with a charter-based regional body and a non-treaty coalition rather than asserted as a definitional contrast.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit,

trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The two principles differ in membership logic, legal form and the kind of outcome each can produce, so the distinction must be drawn on those axes and evidenced with a charter-based regional body and a non-treaty coalition rather than asserted as a definitional contrast.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish regionalism from minilateralism as organising principles for India's diplomatic...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Comment on the proposition that the entry into force of the Bay of Bengal grouping's Charter marks a genuine deepening of South Asian regionalism. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The deepening is real but bounded, so the comment must date the Charter, name the instruments the sixth Summit actually adopted, and then use partial entry into force of the maritime transport agreement to show where integration slows.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened.
- The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment.

- The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified.
- The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body.

Qualified conclusion: The deepening is real but bounded, so the comment must date the Charter, name the instruments the sixth Summit actually adopted, and then use partial entry into force of the maritime transport agreement to show where integration slows.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on "Comment on the proposition that the entry into force of the Bay of Bengal grouping's Charter...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The deepening is real but bounded, so the comment must date the Charter, name the instruments the sixth Summit actually adopted, and then use partial entry into force of the maritime transport agreement to show where integration slows.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation was originally the Bangladesh-India-Myanmar-Sri Lanka-Thailand Economic Cooperation grouping and was since renamed, so the two names are one institutional lineage and not two organisations, and that its Charter was adopted at Colombo on 30 March 2022 and entered into force on 20 May 2024, converting a looser cooperative framework into a charter-based regional organisation of seven members; the examinable consequence is that a regionalism answer can date the institutional deepening precisely instead of asserting an undated claim that regional cooperation has strengthened. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the sixth Summit of the Bay of Bengal grouping met at Bangkok on 4 April 2025 and adopted the Summit Declaration, BIMSTEC Bangkok Vision 2030, the Rules of Procedure for BIMSTEC Mechanisms and the Eminent Persons Group report, endorsed the Leaders' Joint Statement on the Myanmar-Thailand earthquake of 28 March 2025, and that Bangladesh took the chair; the discipline attached is that a vision document, a rules-of-procedure text and an expert-group report are three different evidentiary levels within one cycle, none of which is a treaty obligation, so an answer must cite the instrument by its own name rather than describing the summit as having agreed a binding regional commitment. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an

agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The deepening is real but bounded, so the comment must date the Charter, name the instruments the sixth Summit actually adopted, and then use partial entry into force of the maritime transport agreement to show where integration slows.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Comment on the proposition that the entry into force of the Bay of Bengal grouping's Charter...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine why India's participation in overlapping regional, global and minilateral groupings should be read as multi-alignment rather than indecision. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Overlap is a designed portfolio rather than a lack of choice, so the examination must classify the layers, show that each addresses a non-identical interest, evidence the claim with dated instruments and then concede the coordination and coherence costs honestly.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises.

- The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners.
- The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05.
- The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions.

Qualified conclusion: Overlap is a designed portfolio rather than a lack of choice, so the examination must classify the layers, show that each addresses a non-identical interest, evidence the claim with dated instruments and then concede the coordination and coherence costs honestly.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine why India's participation in overlapping regional, global and minilateral groupings...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Overlap is a designed portfolio rather than a lack of choice, so the examination must classify the layers, show that each addresses a non-identical interest, evidence the claim with dated instruments and then concede the coordination and coherence costs honestly.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners sort every body India joins into five layers: a regional layer defined by geographic contiguity, holding the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation and Mekong-Ganga Cooperation; a trans-regional or oceanic layer holding the Indian Ocean Rim Association and the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative; a continental Eurasian layer holding the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation; a global economic-governance layer holding the Group of Twenty and BRICS; and a minilateral, issue-based layer holding the Quad, the Russia-India-China trilateral and I2U2; the owners require the layer to be named before the body is analysed, because layer decides the membership logic, the mandate and the kind of outcome the body can realistically produce, and a listing of groupings without categorisation is precisely what a comparison question penalises. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners argue that overlapping memberships are a deliberate strategic-autonomy asset rather than institutional redundancy, because each layer addresses a distinct interest and stagnation or exclusion in any one body does not incapacitate the wider architecture, and they anchor the argument in Tharoor's own pairing list of both the United Nations and the Group of Twenty, both the Non-Aligned Movement and the Community of Democracies, both the Group of Seventy-Seven and the Indian Ocean Rim body, and both the South Asian association and ASEAN-linked engagement; the owners then attach three genuine costs in the same place, namely the diplomatic bandwidth and scheduling trade-offs of engaging five layers at once, the analytical imprecision of treating a treaty-bound charter body and a non-treaty coalition as equally binding, and the coherence dilution that follows from platforms containing both India and its principal strategic-mistrust partners. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation as a charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation with ten full members including China, Russia, Pakistan, India, Iran and Belarus, two observers in Afghanistan and Mongolia and fifteen dialogue partners, that India became a full member in 2017, that its 2025 summit at Tianjin on 31 August to 1 September 2025 adopted the Tianjin Declaration and that Kyrgyzstan chairs for 2025 to 2026; the qualification the owners insist on is that membership supplies a seat in continental security and connectivity dialogue but not exclusive influence, because Pakistan's simultaneous membership and China's weight mean common membership never implies common threat perceptions, and the connectivity detail belongs to topic 05. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Group of Twenty as the informal premier forum for international economic cooperation, composed of nineteen states plus the European Union and the African Union with guest countries and invited international organisations attending on a separate footing, that the African Union became a permanent member on 9 September 2023, that the 2025 Summit met at Johannesburg on 22-23 November 2025 and adopted a Leaders' Declaration and that the United States holds the 2026 presidency; they add Tharoor's framing that India's role in this forum runs parallel to its United Nations role rather than replacing it, which is why the global-governance layer must be presented as an addition to, and never a substitute for, formal multilateral institutions. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Overlap is a designed portfolio rather than a lack of choice, so the examination must classify the layers, show that each addresses a non-identical interest, evidence the claim with dated instruments and then concede the coordination and coherence costs honestly.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine why India's participation in overlapping regional, global and minilateral groupings...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation

bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the claim that participation tiers, rather than headline membership, are where the real distinction between these groupings lies. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Tiers are the mechanism by which bodies expand reach without expanding decision rights, so the examination must set out the partner, observer, dialogue-partner and guest categories with named examples and show what each does and does not confer.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026.
- The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership.
- The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity.
- The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty.

Qualified conclusion: Tiers are the mechanism by which bodies expand reach without expanding decision rights, so the examination must set out the partner, observer, dialogue-partner and guest categories with named examples and show what each does and does not confer.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the claim that participation tiers, rather than headline membership, are where the...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Tiers are the mechanism by which bodies expand reach without expanding decision rights, so the examination must set out the partner, observer, dialogue-partner and guest categories with named examples and show what each does and does not confer.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record BRICS as an intergovernmental political and economic grouping rather than a treaty alliance, originally Brazil, Russia, India and China, later expanded with South Africa and further members to eleven full members, with a separate partner-country category of ten countries created through the Kazan process on 24 October 2024, that the seventeenth Summit at Rio de Janeiro on 6-7 July 2025 issued the Rio de Janeiro Declaration, and that India launched its 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026 under the formulation Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability; the owners require partner countries to be kept out of the membership count and a chairship launch to be kept apart from a completed summit outcome, since no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome was officially verified as of 3 August 2026. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as a treaty and charter-based Southeast Asian regional organisation of eleven members including Timor-Leste, admitted at the forty-seventh ASEAN Summit on 26 October 2025, with a separate dialogue-partner tier that India has held in full since 1995, and they record that the twenty-second ASEAN-India Summit met at Kuala Lumpur on the same day and that the current framework is the ASEAN-India Plan of Action to implement the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership for 2026 to 2030 while the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement remained ongoing rather than concluded; the owners also record that ASEAN maintains separate trade agreements with China, South Korea, Japan, India, Australia-New Zealand and Hong Kong, and that the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership links ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand while India is not a member of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation, as an intergovernmental regional organisation of twenty-three member states with twelve dialogue partners and a Secretariat at Ebene in Mauritius, that India assumed its two-year chair in November 2025 for 2025 to 2027, and that its twenty-fourth Council of Ministers met virtually on 21 May 2025 and adopted the Colombo Communique; they add that Tharoor cites this body explicitly as one of the platforms India engages alongside larger organisations under its multi-alignment approach, which makes it a citable example of reach that does not depend on geographic contiguity. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners assemble the export-control and financial-institution distinctions that the objective ledger repeatedly targets: India joined the Missile Technology Control Regime as its thirty-fifth member on 27 June 2016, and that regime is a voluntary export-control arrangement giving rule access rather than a treaty guaranteeing technology transfer; India is not a member of the Nuclear Suppliers Group and its application is distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce, because a waiver is not membership and admission requires consensus; India is a founding member and the second-largest shareholder of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank after China, which supplies finance access and a governance stake without unilateral control; and India's International Atomic Energy Agency safeguards Additional Protocol entered into force on 25 July 2014, applying to its safeguards arrangement without making it a non-nuclear-weapon State under the Non-Proliferation Treaty. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security,

economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Tiers are the mechanism by which bodies expand reach without expanding decision rights, so the examination must set out the partner, observer, dialogue-partner and guest categories with named examples and show what each does and does not confer.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the claim that participation tiers, rather than headline membership, are where the...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the proposition that institutional form, and not diplomatic energy, decides what a grouping can deliver for India. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Form largely determines delivery but does not exhaust it, so the assessment must run the treaty-bound to non-treaty spectrum, evidence both ends with dated instruments, and close on the judgement that matching institutional form to the problem matters more than multiplying memberships.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified.
- The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption.
- The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4

October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment.

- The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them.

Qualified conclusion: Form largely determines delivery but does not exhaust it, so the assessment must run the treaty-bound to non-treaty spectrum, evidence both ends with dated instruments, and close on the judgement that matching institutional form to the problem matters more than multiplying memberships.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the proposition that institutional form, and not diplomatic energy, decides what a...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Form largely determines delivery but does not exhaust it, so the assessment must run the treaty-bound to non-treaty spectrum, evidence both ends with dated instruments, and close on the judgement that matching institutional form to the problem matters more than multiplying memberships.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation was signed on 3 April 2025 and entered into force on 16 May 2026 among only four of the seven members, namely Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026, and they treat this as the clearest available demonstration that an agreement in force and an agreement binding the whole region are different claims; the analytical sharpening is that variable-geometry ratification, rather than summit reluctance, is where regional integration actually slows, and the owners separately note that the framework agreement for a BIMSTEC free trade area dates from 8 February 2004 with no concluded free trade agreement verified. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the Quad as a non-treaty consultative minilateral of India, Australia, Japan and the United States with a maritime-security and Indo-Pacific cooperation focus and

acknowledged asymmetry among its members' treaty relationships, that the most recent Leaders' Summit was at Wilmington, Delaware on 21 September 2024 and the most recent Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on 26 May 2026, which launched the Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Cooperation initiative and a Quad Initiative on Indo-Pacific Energy Security and announced a Quad Critical Minerals Framework, and that the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative was launched on 1 July 2025; the owners state honestly that India was announced as intended host of a Leaders' Summit but that no India-hosted Leaders' Summit and no formal postponement is officially verified, so the gap is stated rather than filled by assumption. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The North Atlantic Treaty Organization page checked live on 2026-09-03 records that twelve countries signed the North Atlantic Treaty, also known as the Washington Treaty, on 4 April 1949 in Washington, D.C., naming Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom and the United States, and that all twelve parliaments ratified within the following five months, while the alliance's own Article 5 page records that the attacks of 11 September 2001 led it to take action under Article 5 for the first and so far only time in its history, that the North Atlantic Council agreed a conditional determination on 12 September 2001 and confirmed it on 2 October 2001, that a package of eight support measures was agreed on 4 October 2001 and that Operation Eagle Assist ran from 9 October 2001 to mid-May 2002 with seven airborne early-warning aircraft, 830 crew members from 13 member countries and over 360 sorties; the owners add that Finland joined in 2023 and Sweden became the thirty-second member in March 2024, that the North Atlantic Council decides by consensus, and that India is neither a member nor a treaty ally, so the alliance affects India only indirectly through Russia-West confrontation, defence and technology alignment, sanctions coordination and the allocation of Western attention, and must never be conflated with a non-treaty functional minilateral that carries no collective-defence commitment. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Form largely determines delivery but does not exhaust it, so the assessment must run the treaty-bound to non-treaty spectrum, evidence both ends with dated instruments, and close on the judgement that matching institutional form to the problem matters more than multiplying memberships.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the proposition that institutional form, and not diplomatic energy, decides what a...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess how India should present the record of its grouping diplomacy without either overstating success or conceding incoherence. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Honesty is itself an analytical asset, so the assessment must name the stagnant body, the asymmetric trilaterals, the surviving membership gap and the unverified summit, and then show why a dated and bounded record supports a stronger strategic-autonomy claim than an unqualified one.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body.
- The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger.
- The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact.
- The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand

whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them.

Qualified conclusion: Honesty is itself an analytical asset, so the assessment must name the stagnant body, the asymmetric trilaterals, the surviving membership gap and the unverified summit, and then show why a dated and bounded record supports a stronger strategic-autonomy claim than an unqualified one.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess how India should present the record of its grouping diplomacy without either...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Honesty is itself an analytical asset, so the assessment must name the stagnant body, the asymmetric trilaterals, the surviving membership gap and the unverified summit, and then show why a dated and bounded record supports a stronger strategic-autonomy claim than an unqualified one.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation as a charter-based South Asian regional organisation with eight members and an observer tier whose last Summit held was the eighteenth, at Kathmandu on 26-27 November 2014, and whose momentum has been constrained by India-Pakistan tensions; they state flatly that the organisation continues to exist and that dissolution must not be asserted without a specific verified source, and they add the analytical point that continued underperformance of the South Asian framework is an unrealised regional-integration opportunity rather than a costless substitution by another body. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that Sikri names the India-Brazil-South Africa Initiative and the Russia-India-China trilateral as potentially significant smaller platforms that let India engage major powers or Southern peers without the constraints of a larger and more heterogeneous body, that an India-Brazil-South Africa Leaders' Meeting was held at Johannesburg on 23 November 2025 proposing a digital innovation alliance and a climate-resilient agriculture fund as proposals rather than established institutions, and that the Russia-India-China trilateral has no officially verified meeting since the eighteenth Foreign Ministers' Meeting convened virtually on 26 November 2021; the owners require this asymmetry to be stated candidly whenever the two are listed together, because presenting them as equally active misdescribes the ledger. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record Sikri's observation that India had failed to obtain membership of either the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum or the Asia-Europe Meeting as a book-period statement rather than a current two-forum gap, because India joined the Asia-Europe Meeting in 2007 while it remained outside the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum as of 3 August 2026; they treat the correction as a corrective to

triumphalist narratives, since platform diversification has not been uniformly successful, and they require the surviving example to be dated whenever it is used so that a period-specific source claim is never presented as a present-day fact. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence.

Qualification: State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The audited ledgers route six General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, each on a Core route recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership: 2020 question 19 on the Quadrilateral Security Dialogue allegedly transforming itself from a military alliance into a trade bloc, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words for which the 2020 paper is not among the locally held official papers, so the wording is carried from the ledger and the owner rather than confirmed here; 2021 question 19 asking to critically examine the aims and objectives of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and the importance it holds for India, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question itself; 2022 question 10 asking whether the Bay of Bengal grouping is a parallel organisation like the South Asian association, what the similarities and dissimilarities are and how Indian foreign-policy objectives are realized by forming it, a 10-mark demand whose 150-word limit is printed in the question; 2022 question 19 on how the I2U2 grouping will transform India's position in global politics, a 15-mark demand whose 250-word limit is printed in the question; 2023 question 9 stating that a virus of conflict is affecting the functioning of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation and asking the answer to point out India's role in mitigating the problems, a 10-mark demand whose printed tail carries only the mark value so that its 150-word limit comes from the paper's instruction block; and 2023 question 19 on whether the expansion and strengthening of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization and a stronger United States-Europe strategic partnership works well for India, a 15-mark demand on the same instruction-block provenance; the objective ledgers additionally route seventeen demands from 2018 to 2023, four from 2024 to 2025 and three from 2026 to this owner, and because the 2018-2023 official keys are not held locally, the 2024-2025 Set-A keys are held and the 2026 Set-A key is provisional, no option, answer letter or inferred key is recorded for any of them.

Analysis: Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Honesty is itself an analytical asset, so the assessment must name the stagnant body, the asymmetric trilaterals, the surviving membership gap and the unverified summit, and then show why a dated and bounded record supports a stronger strategic-autonomy claim than an unqualified one.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess how India should present the record of its grouping diplomacy without either...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.